

ACME Corp: Employee Leave Policy Handbook

1. Sick Leave

All full-time employees accrue sick leave starting from their first day of employment. Employees receive twelve days of paid sick leave per calendar year, which is accrued at a steady rate of one day per month. Sick leave can be used for personal illness, medical appointments, mental health days, or caring for an immediate family member who is ill. To utilize this leave, employees must notify their manager via email or Slack by 8:30 AM on the day of their absence. Please note that a formal medical certificate must be submitted to HR for any sick leave absences exceeding three consecutive days.

2. Vacation Leave

Full-time employees become eligible to take accrued vacation leave after completing their initial ninety-day probationary period. The company provides fifteen days of paid vacation leave per calendar year. Unused vacation days up to a maximum of five days can be carried over to the next calendar year, after which any remaining unused balance is forfeited. Vacation leave must be requested and approved by the line manager at least two weeks in advance to ensure adequate team coverage. Additionally, vacation requests during peak operational periods such as the Q4 year-end closing may be restricted based on business needs.

3. Bereavement Leave

Bereavement leave is available to all employees immediately upon hire to help them manage difficult personal times. The policy provides up to five consecutive paid days off for the loss of an immediate family member, which includes a spouse, child, parent, or sibling. For extended family members such as grandparents, aunts, uncles, or in-laws, the company provides up to three consecutive paid days off. This leave is intended for making arrangements and attending services, and employees should notify HR and their manager as soon as practical. Additional unpaid time can be requested if long-distance travel is required.

4. Maternity Leave

Full-time female employees who have been with the company for a minimum of twelve continuous months are eligible for paid maternity leave. Eligible employees receive sixteen weeks of fully paid maternity leave, which can commence up to four weeks prior to the expected

date of delivery. A formal request along with a medical certificate stating the expected delivery date must be submitted to HR at least thirty days before the intended start of the leave. Upon completion of the leave, ACME Corp guarantees that the employee will return to their same position or an equivalent role with the matching salary and benefits.

5. Adoption and Surrogacy Leave

The company supports all paths to parenthood by providing adoption and surrogacy leave to eligible employees who have completed at least twelve months of continuous service. The primary caregiver is entitled to twelve weeks of fully paid leave to bond with the child, starting from the official date of placement or the child's birth via surrogacy. A formal application for this leave along with official legal documentation from the adoption agency or surrogacy agreement must be submitted to HR at least thirty days prior to the expected leave date.

6. Paternity and Co-Parent Leave

To support new parents, the company provides paid paternity and co-parent leave to full-time employees following the birth, adoption, or surrogacy placement of a child. Eligible employees receive four weeks of fully paid leave to assist with family transitions and bonding. This leave must be taken within the first six months of the child's arrival and can be taken all at once or split into two-week blocks with prior managerial approval. Employees are requested to give their manager at least thirty days of advance notice whenever possible.

7. Jury Duty and Civil Leave

ACME Corp recognizes an employee's civic duty and provides paid time off for jury service or required court appearances as a witness. Employees will receive their full regular salary for up to two weeks of jury service, provided they submit a copy of the official jury summons to HR as soon as they receive it. If jury duty extends beyond two weeks, the remaining time will be treated as unpaid leave, though employees may choose to use accrued vacation days to cover the gap. Employees are expected to report back to work on any day they are dismissed early from court.